

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



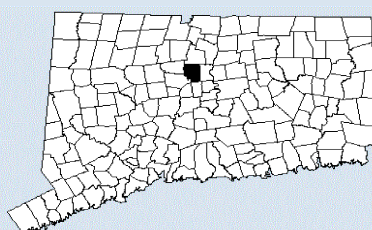
West Hartford School District

Paul Vicinus Jr., Superintendent • 860-561-6600 • www.whps.org/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	25
Enrollment	9,261
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,704
Total Expenditures ¹	\$199,027,411

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	4,558	49.2	48.3
Male	4,691	50.7	51.5
Non-Binary	12	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	22	0.2	0.2
Asian	960	10.4	5.2
Black or African American	751	8.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,974	21.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	17	0.2	0.1
Two or More Races	570	6.2	4.7
White	4,967	53.6	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	790	8.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,573	27.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	1,648	17.8	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	511	11.3	238	4.9
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	123	17.2	73	9.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	392	20.7	153	7.3
White	310	6.4	109	2.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	144	17.5	27	3.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	533	21.8	220	7.7
Students with Disabilities	372	23.6	153	8.0
District	976	10.9	369	3.9
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 693

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	631.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	115.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	119.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	269.7
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	21.7
School Level	39.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	16.0
Support Staff	12.1
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	52.4
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	76.6
School Nurses	20.9
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	436.8

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.2	0.1
Asian	23	2.4	1.4
Black or African American	29	3.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	40	4.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	878	90.3	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.5	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	42	76.4	74	94.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	130	76.5	142	95.9
White	348	87.0	422	98.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	15	39.5	36	87.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	141	75.0	196	96.1
Students with Disabilities	66	59.5	161	94.7
District	629	84.8	770	97.8
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	131	51.0
Emotional Disability	24	48.0
Intellectual Disability	7	20.0
Learning Disability	439	72.3
Other Health Impairment	220	72.1
Other Disabilities	32	34.8
Speech/Language Impairment	177	87.6
District	1,030	66.5
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	265	2.9	2.6
Emotional Disability	50	0.5	1.1
Intellectual Disability	36	0.4	0.6
Learning Disability	607	6.6	6.4
Other Health Impairment	311	3.4	3.5
Other Disabilities	125	1.4	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	250	2.7	2.0
All Disabilities	1,644	17.9	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	39	2.4	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	171	10.4	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$125,068,442	\$13,010	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$15,688,198	\$1,718	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$7,949,912	\$870	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$4,385,829	\$480	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$13,461,750	\$1,474	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$2,764,074	\$303	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$16,458,975	\$1,802	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$11,318,738	\$2,163	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,931,493	\$211	\$213
Total	\$199,027,411	\$20,704	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$18,106,034	31.9	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$6,588,975	11.6	10.2
Other Salaries	\$2,925,292	5.2	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$7,516,070	13.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$4,196,814	7.4	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$11,694,872	20.6	22.2
Supplies	\$232,589	0.4	0.7
Property Services	\$29,430	0.1	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$5,418,955	9.6	8.4
Equipment	\$19,168	0.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$56,728,199	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.5	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	79.7
State	14.6
Federal	4.8
Tuition & Other	0.8

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	461	77.4	458	77.7	209	79.2
Black or African American	358	61.0	357	56.0	156	57.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	977	58.6	973	55.2	432	57.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	293	78.7	292	75.3	108	75.5
White	2,503	79.1	2,501	76.1	1,123	78.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	549	57.7	545	58.0	190	54.2
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	4,056	75.2	4,048	71.9	1,844	74.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,220	57.5	1,214	54.1	517	56.4
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,385	78.7	3,379	76.0	1,517	77.7
Students with Disabilities	812	51.3	805	46.6	329	47.6
Students without Disabilities	3,793	77.7	3,788	75.2	1,705	77.1
High Needs	1,825	59.1	1,813	55.9	761	57.1
Non-High Needs	2,780	82.3	2,780	79.5	1,273	81.4
District	4,605	73.1	4,593	70.2	2,034	72.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	72.4	69.5	67.5	69.6	2,612	69.8
Curl Up	77.9	85.9	78.0	84.7	2,602	81.6
Push Up	66.2	71.5	73.7	69.4	2,597	70.2
Mile Run/PACER	73.1	68.3	60.1	42.6	2,583	60.9
All Tests - District	42.3	42.8	39.3	27.1	2,571	37.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	67	89.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	137	83.9
White	429	96.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	23	56.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	223	86.5
Students with Disabilities	104	71.2
District	741	92.8
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	522	71.3
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	63	47.4
Hispanic or Latino	115	36.2
White	641	77.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	11	13.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	161	41.1
Students with Disabilities	44	15.7
District	1,011	66.1
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	87.3	95.0
Male	79.0	92.8
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	79.4	93.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	68.0	88.4
White	86.7	94.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	70.0	88.7
Students with Disabilities	48.5	87.2
District	83.0	93.9
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	73.1	75	48.7	50	97.4	63.9
	High Needs Students	59.1	75	39.4	50	78.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	70.2	75	46.8	50	93.6	60.2
	High Needs Students	55.9	75	37.3	50	74.6	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	72.3	75	48.2	50	96.4	61.8
	High Needs Students	57.1	75	38.0	50	76.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	62.0%	100%	62.0	100	62.0	58.7%
	High Needs Students	54.6%	100%	54.6	100	54.6	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	67.3%	100%	67.3	100	67.3	61.4%
	High Needs Students	57.8%	100%	57.8	100	57.8	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	64.9%	100%	32.4	50	64.9	58.9%
	Oral	62.9%	100%	31.4	50	62.9	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	10.9%	<=5%	38.3	50	76.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	20.5%	<=5%	19.0	50	38.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	91.5%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	66.1%	75%	44.1	50	88.2	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.3%	94%	48.0	50	96.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		92.8%	94%	98.8	100	98.8	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		92.5%	94%	98.4	100	98.4	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		83.0%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		95.4% 37.8%	75%	25.2	50	50.4	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		41.2%	60%	34.3	50	68.6	55.0%
Accountability Index				1120.1	1450	77.2	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.1	15.9	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	55.9	19.1	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	57.1	17.9	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.5%	1.5%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.1
	High Needs Students	98.2
Math	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	97.7
Science	All Students	98.3
	High Needs Students	96.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 59.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

West Hartford Public Schools (WHPS) aligns its District Development Plan (DDP) to the West Hartford Board of Education's goals. The DDP goals are articulated as multi-year efforts toward systemic improvement. Strategic efforts are grounded in collaboration, core standards, best instructional practices, and quality professional learning. Recent areas of focus include establishing weekly professional learning communities, family engagement initiatives, culturally relevant and student-centered instructional practice, social emotional learning, restorative practice implementation, and improvements to special education programming.

School Development Plans align to the DDP and are designed to support the needs of each school. Building leaders articulate improvement plans based on their school's performance relative to student metrics and teacher performance. Classroom teachers receive reports on the achievement of their students in professional learning communities, review student work, and adjust instruction. The district's early release Wednesday model provides dedicated professional learning time to support district, school, and grade-level initiatives as well as individual professional learning goals. School Development goals focus on enhancing the culture and climate of each school including implementing restorative practices, addressing root cause of absenteeism, and partnering with families to support students academic, social, and emotional growth.

The Office of Equity Advancement has expanded its partnership with families to maintain structures that engage families under our Vision for Equity. District and school teams have coordinated efforts to secure grants for student engagement and community partnerships, panel discussions on social justice in collaboration, and parent partnership activities related to family outreach, communications, curriculum review, professional learning and other forms of community engagement. The district partners with the One Community network of families, educators and community members as well as West Hartford's family led Community of Care to provide information on important topics affecting the lives of children and families. Furthermore, The Office of Equity Advancement leads efforts to influence practices related to diversity in curricula, enrichment programming, BIPOC student/ parent engagement and more.

The District maintains a focus on the effective integration between general and special education. District leadership monitors delivery of educational services and inclusion practices. Recent changes to programming include: the addition of Assistant Principals at the elementary schools to support students with IEPs, 504 plans, and those in the SST process. The district recently added a district supported community bookstore as a second vocational training location for our Post-Secondary Transition students; enhancements to alternative programs (STRIVE and School Engagement) to increase active engagement and social and emotional well-being; training for clinicians in SEL interventions; and the inclusion of school counselors at the elementary level to support student regulation.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a diverse community, West Hartford is one of the few towns in the state whose percent of minority students and students eligible for free and reduced lunch both closely resemble the state average. During our 182-day school year, there are innumerable opportunities within a student's normal instructional settings for interactions between students of different races, ethnicity, and socio-economic groups.

Beyond the day-to-day activities available to all students, the district has strong participation in a variety of programs that promote reduced racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. Approximately 425 students attend inter-district magnet, charter, and vo-tech schools and educates over 200 Open Choice students. West Hartford has two magnet elementary schools with a total enrollment of 867 students and a magnet enrollment of 368 students. The district actively recruits minority staff members and participates in CREC Minority Job Fairs, UCONN Job Fairs and hosts a district career fair. WHPS supports its Future Educators of Diversity Program, an affinity group for young people of color interested in the teaching profession. WHPS partners in the CREC CT Teacher Residency Program to train and support diverse candidates.

The district has established an Office of Equity Advancement that reports directly to the Superintendent to support educational initiatives to reduce racial, ethnic and economic isolation. The district sponsors grant and town funded positions serving as outreach coordinators to support families of English learners and liaisons to town services. The school board has taken an active role in supporting programs, providing resources and has recently passed a policy statement on educational equity. The Board continues to support magnet schools, HANOC, The Bridge Family Center, Graustein Memorial Fund Discovery Project, Summer Academy, Hello! West Hartford, West Hartford Celebration of Dr. Martin Luther King, an LGBTQ+ Alliance, Equity and Diversity Council, community conversations regarding diversity, the renaming of the high school mascots, training in Culturally Responsive Pedagogy and Trauma Informed Practice, Summer Connections and ESOL Summer Programs, and the Alternative High School programs.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

During the budgeting process, the district carefully evaluates the needs of each school and program. Funding decisions are based on key criteria, some of which are uniform, while others are based on special needs at the building level.

Staffing Levels: Student-teacher ratios are established at the district level. Staff are allocated based on the school's enrollment and, at the high school, the number of students taking a particular course. There are reduced student-teacher ratios at two of the district elementary schools based on the educational needs of those students.

Instructional Supplies: Many textbooks and supplies are purchased centrally. In addition, each building receives a per-pupil allocation for locally identified instructional needs.

Building Operating Expenses: The operating and maintenance expenses at each building are centrally funded to ensure an adequately maintained school and a safe and appropriate environment for instruction.